**Okayama University**
**Graduate School of Interdisciplinary Science and Engineering in Health Systems**
**Leadership and SDGs（リーダーシップと SDGs）**
**Course Number: 2026490034**
**Syllabus For: Term 3 and 4 (2026)**
**Friday 10:45-12:35**

Instructor: Dr. Mamoru Ishida（石田衛　岡山大学学術研究院　共通教育・グローバル領域）
Contact: 石田 衛 | チャット | Microsoft Teams
Office Hours (online):
Office Hours (online): Tuesdays 3:00-5:00 p.m. and Fridays 3:00-5:00 p.m.
**Contact for an appointment is appreciated.**

**Contacting Procedure**
**The subject line of your message should contain the course name, the course number, and your faculty (department) title. E.g.) Quiz Question (Leadership and SDGs, 2025332001, Graduate School of Education)**

**Course Description:**
This course provides a foundational and interdisciplinary understanding of leadership. Current issues in leadership and case studies are also discussed. Students will also develop their own philosophy of leadership to help them become problem-solvers for application to enhancing the effectiveness of SDGs.

**Learning Objectives:**
The purpose of this course is to provide an overview of leadership theory and its application that crosses various fields to help solve problems for the SDGs initiative. Since the SDGs are fundamentally about creating a more just and equitable world, where all people have the opportunity to thrive, the purpose of this course studying in English particularly is to understand the SDGs knowledge and problem-solving skills in English and develop a sense of global citizenship for fostering an appreciation for diverse cultures, perspectives, and experiences.

Thus, through practice of English-speaking work environment and cross-cultural interactions in class, the purpose of this course for graduate students to also learn to reflect and cope with some of the communication difficulties involved in conducting business with partners from different cultural backgrounds.

**Learner-Centered Outcomes:**
Upon completion of this course, the successful student should be able to:

1. Recognize key concepts and major theories of leadership.
2. Examine different leadership styles and approaches, comparing their effectiveness in various contexts.
3. Formulate a leadership vision that reflects personal goals and values within the context of the SDGs.
4. Suggest leadership solutions for global issues in their own field of expertise, incorporating diversity and ethical perspectives.

**Optional Readings:**
Daft, R. L. (2018). *The leadership experience*. Seventh Edition. Boston, MA: Cengage.

Wheeler, D. W. (2012). *Servant leadership for higher education: Principles and practices*. San Francisco, CA: Jossey-Bass.

**Q&A Forum:**

To enhance learning outcomes and foster a "learning community" where knowledge is shared among students, this course has specific guidelines for handling questions. For questions regarding course content or assignments, post them to the **"Q&A Forum"** on Moodle instead of sending an email.

- **Shared Learning:** Your question is likely someone else's question. Sharing it helps the entire class learn more effectively.
- **Peer-to-Peer Support: L**earning through mutual support is encouraged. When students help one another—whether the instructor is available or not—they often discover answers more quickly and develop a stronger sense of collaboration. Classmates can offer timely insights based on shared experiences, making peer assistance an essential resource for solving problems efficiently.

**In principle,** your email regarding a general question **will be responded with a reminder to review** the Q&A Forum**, instead of replied individually.**

**Course Outline:**
Follow the tentative outline of topics, video on demand (VOD) lectures, and course assignments (due dates) below. All assignments except readings are due at **23:59** on the designated dates (***: Counted as your weekly attendance)**

**Week 1 (10/1- 10/9)**
Course Introduction and Course Syllabus Review
*Syllabus/Critical Thinking Assessment and Discussion Forum: Introducing Yourself (10/9)
Initial Reflection (10/9)

**Week 2 (10/10-10/16)** <In-Class>
Orientation and Introduction to Leadership
* Follow-up Reflection and Leadership Development Goal (In-Class)

**Week 3 (10/17-10/23)**
What Does It Mean to Be a Leader? (VOD)
*Quiz 1 (10/23): What Does It Mean to Be a Leader

**Week 4 (10/24-10/30)**
Collaboration and Leadership
*Collaboration and Leadership Reflection

**Week 5 (10/31-11/6)** <In-Class>
Exploring Leadership and SDGs as a Global Citizen
Reading: The SDGs and English Language Teaching
*Intercultural Co-learning Survey (In-Class)

**Week 6 (11/7-11/13)**
Diversity in Leadership (VOD)
*Quiz 2 (11/6): Diversity in Leadership

**Week 7 (11/14-11/20)**
Leadership Theories I: Trait Approach, Skills Approach, & Behavioral Approach (VOD)
*Quiz 3 (11/20): Leadership Theories I

**Week 8 (11/21-11/27)**
Leadership Theories II: Situational Approach, Path-Goal Theory, & Leader-Member Exchange (VOD)
*Quiz 4 (11/27): Leadership Theories II

**Week 9 (11/28-12/4)**
Leadership Theories III: Transformational Leadership, Coalitional Leadership, and Power & Influence (VOD)
*Quiz 5 (12/4): Leadership Theories III
Personal Leadership Philosophy Essay Body Paragraphs I and II (12/10)

**Week 10 (12/5-12/11) <**In-Class**>**
Personal Leadership Philosophy and In-Class Peer Review (Bring your Essay Body Paragraphs I and II to the In-Class Session.)
*Reflection: Evaluation of Your Peer's Feedback (In-Class)
Course Survey

**Week 11 (12/12-12/18)**
Personal Leadership Philosophy Essay
The New Reality of Leadership (VOD)
*Personal Leadership Philosophy Essay (12/18)

**Week 12 (12/19-1/8)**
Personal Leadership Philosophy and Online Peer Review
Peer Review Response (12/25)
*Revised Personal Leadership Philosophy Essay (1/8)

**Week 13 (1/9-1/15)**
Leading Teams (VOD)
*Quiz 6 (1/15): Leadership Teams

**Week 14 (1/16-1/22)**
Strategic Leadership (VOD)
*Quiz 7 (1/22): Strategic Leadership

**Week 15 (1/23-29)**
Leading Change (VOD)
*Quiz 8 (1/29): Leading Change

**<In-Class Sessions>**

Attendance in these synchronous class sessions is considered a necessary factor in the learning process. For each day, students can select attending in the following classroom.

**Dates: 10/16, 11/6, and 12/11**
**Time: 13:25 – 14:55**

**Requirements for Credit:**
Students will participate in academic writing experience, presentation preparation, review of literature, analysis of oral/visual presentation, critical thinking exercise, online discussion, online research, and group work. Teams and Moodle provide specific instructions for assignments and evaluation rubric charts.

The three R's communicate expectations for fulfillment of requirements for course credit. They are:
**Read** all assigned material
**Real** experiences – observations, historical site visits, cultural activities, academic research…etc.
**Reflect** – oral and written reflections; both informal and formal

| Expectations for Fulfillment of Requirements "3R's" | Required Assignment for Credit | LCOs |
|---|---|---|
| **Readings** | Course Required Readings (including VOD)<br>Quizzes | 1 |
| **Real Experiences** | Class Sessions<br>Group Discussions | 2,4 |
| **Reflection** | Reflection Assignments<br>Personal Leadership Philosophy Essay | 3,4 |

| | |
|---|---|
| Initial Reflection | **20 pts** |
| Syllabus/Critical Thinking Assessment | **20 pts** |
| Follow-up Reflection and Leadership Development Goal Submission | **30 pts** |
| Collaboration and Leadership Reflection | **30 pts** |
| Intercultural Co-learning Survey | **20 pts** |
| Quizzes (30 pts x 8) | **240 pts** |
| Peer Review Response Submission | **50 pts** |
| Reflection: Evaluation of Your Peer's Feedback | **30 pts** |
| Revised Personal Leadership Philosophy Submission | **50 pts** |
| Course Survey | **10 pts** |
| **TOTAL** | **500 pts** |

The policy on writing assignments is designed to encourage the timely completion of assignments to insure the return of graded assignments in a timely manner.

- Citations should conform to the writing style and reference guidelines found in the *Publication Manual for the American Psychological Association* (7th edition). Guidelines can be found here for free: https://apastyle.apa.org/style-grammar-guidelines and https://apastyle.apa.org/instructional-aids/handouts-guides.
- Double space (Microsoft Word) using an appropriate 12-point, Times New Roman, black color font, and one-inch margins.
- Assignments are to be completed by the individual except when teams or groups are noted and encouraged.
- Unexcused work **will not** be accepted, except in extraordinary circumstances. Unexcused work, for clarification sake, are assignments turned in past the due date without prior notice and approval of the instructor.

**Attendance Policy:**
According to Okayama University academic policy, attendance in class is considered a necessary factor in the learning process. Therefore, absences for all reasons must be kept to a minimum and should not exceed 25 percent of the total class time. Students are held responsible for all academic work required or performed during their absence regardless of the reasons for those absences. Students who register late are responsible for work missed. The policy concerning class attendance for individual courses, seminars, or other guided learning experiences will be determined by the faculty members in charge of such course, seminar, or learning experience.

Regarding the class meetings via Teams, test your technology before each meeting, and resolve any technical issues. Your audio and video systems must be clear and stable. Find a quiet space to participate and close other browsers during the meeting for maximizing stability. Do not multi-task

(do other work) during the meeting. Use the mute button at your site to prevent transmitting background noise.

**Learner-Centered Assessment of Outcomes:**

I. Class Participation, Discussion Forum, and Reflection
Class participation is considered a necessary factor in the learning process and the training for leadership development. The classroom experience is enriched when students make relevant contributions in the form of comments and questions; therefore, participation in class discussions and learning activities is expected and encouraged.

II. **Quizzes**

Each student is responsible for taking quizzes for the designated weeks. You must take each quiz within 30 min. before the due date. Because each student may try one attempt only, please confirm all your answers before submitting your attempt and make sure to submit it when you finish each quiz.

III. **Personal Leadership Philosophy Essay**

Write a five-paragraph essay that explores the development of your personal leadership philosophy. Based on your life experiences, describe how your understanding of leadership has evolved over time. Identify key turning points, such as specific events, challenges, or influential people who shaped your current perspective. Reflect on your personal values, strengths, and weaknesses, and ultimately define what leadership means to you today. Review the following page, **Essay Assignment Instruction**, for more information.

Your essay needs to be three to four pages in total. When you submit your essay in Moodle, the following format needs to be used for your file name:
Last name, First name Personal Leadership Philosophy Essay
(E.g. Ishida, Mamoru Personal Leadership Philosophy Essay)

- Peer Review Response: Read randomly assigned classmate's essay and provide feedback via Moodle. First, discuss if the components needed in the essay listed above are included or not. Next, share what you thought of the highlights of the essay, and recognize unclear or vague sentences/ideas. Finally, list some strengths of the essay and some areas of improvement.
- Revised Personal Leadership Philosophy Submission: Based on the feedback received from peer reviews, revise your writing for your leadership philosophy and submit topic sentences and support sentences for each paragraph via the designated form in Moodle.

**Grading:**

| Grad | % value |
|---|---|
| A+ | 100-90 |
| A | 89-80 |
| B | 79-70 |
| C | 69-60 |
| F | 59-0 |

**Method of Instruction:**
Students will receive instruction and experience in group discussion, learning via Moodle, outlining, writing styles, observations of different cultures, short topic writing, oral presentation, visual aids, and

research skills. Class discussion, lecture, Moodle course extension, Power Point presentations, online video clips, Zoom/Teams meetings, and the Internet will be used. Before starting your online study, including taking quizzes and submitting your assignments, make sure that you have access to a steady Internet connection. Students are held responsible for all academic work not submitted correctly due to failure of Internet connection.

Furthermore, when Google forms and other related tools are utilized, be sure to use your Okayama University student account to access them. Before starting your course work, make sure that you have access to each necessary digital tool. Each student holds a full responsibility for an access to each necessary digital tool and contact 情報統括センター, if needed.

Additionally, make sure that you have access to necessary translation apps/tools, if you need them. If you are unfamiliar with any, consider the following and use of its app on your digital device to translate texts via its camera.
DeepL

**Essay Assignment Instruction: Personal Leadership Philosophy**

This essay should follow a clear five-paragraph structure, focusing on how your leadership philosophy has evolved through personal experience.

- Introduction
  - Introduce your current idea of what leadership means to you.
  - Briefly mention key experiences that shaped this idea.
  - End with a thesis statement explaining how your leadership philosophy has developed over time.

- Body Paragraph 1: A Turning Point Before Entering University
  - Describe a specific event or moment before university that first made you think about leadership.
  - Where and when did it happen? Who was involved?
  - What did you feel and learn? How did it shape your early values (e.g., responsibility, empathy, fairness)?

*Example: An experience in middle or high school when you took responsibility in a team project or supported a friend in need.*

- Body Paragraph 2: A Leadership Experience During University Life
  - Choose a specific situation in university where you had to show leadership (formal or informal).
  - Describe the context, your actions, the outcome, and how your feelings changed through the experience.
  - What did you learn about yourself and others through this experience?

*Example: Organizing an event, managing a group project, or supporting a struggling teammate.*

- Body Paragraph 3: Influential Relationships That Shaped Your Values this Semester
  - Write about a leadership theory/concept you learned this semester and a person who practiced it in a way that significantly influenced your leadership philosophy (e.g., a family member, teacher, senior, supervisor, or peer).
  - What did this person do or say that influenced you?
  - Looking back, which leadership theory or concept best explains why their influence was meaningful to you?

*Example: A parent who modeled servant leadership through consistent listening, a teacher who demonstrated transformational leadership by encouraging you to think critically, or a classmate who showed strong cultural intelligence during class discussions.*

- Conclusion
  - Summarize the key turning points in your leadership journey.
  - Define what leadership means to you today in your own words.
  - Mention how your learning experiences this semester affected your leadership actions.
  - Connect your philosophy to broader goals like the SDGs.